

Vercel Deployment Guide for SchemeSaathi (Saathi) Project

Overview

This guide walks you through deploying the **SchemeSaathi** React/Vite application to **Vercel** from a fresh environment, starting from cloning the GitHub repository to having a live URL. It also includes local-development instructions (using the provided `start.bat` and `HOW_TO_START.txt`).

Prerequisites

1. **Git** – [Download \(https://git-scm.com/downloads\)](https://git-scm.com/downloads) and install.
2. **Node.js (LTS)** – version 20.x recommended. Install from <https://nodejs.org/>.
3. **pnpm** (fast package manager used by the project). Install globally: `npm i -g pnpm`.
4. **Vercel Account** – sign-up at <https://vercel.com/signup> (free tier is sufficient).
5. **Vercel CLI (optional but convenient)** – `npm i -g vercel` (requires Node).

Clone the Repository

```
git clone https://github.com/rajsolankar31/saathi.git
cd saathi
```

Install Dependencies

The project uses a **pnpm workspace**. From the repository root run:

```
pnpm install
```

This will install all workspace packages, including the UI located in `artifacts/scheme-saathi`.

Local Development (Optional)

You can start the app locally using the provided Windows batch file or manually.

Using `start.bat` (Windows)

```
start.bat
```

The script checks for Node, installs dependencies if missing, launches the Vite dev server (`pnpm --filter @workspace/scheme-saathi run dev`) and opens the browser at `http://localhost:5173/`.

Manual Steps (Cross-platform)

```
# Install dependencies if you haven't already
pnpm install

# Start development server
npx pnpm --filter @workspace/scheme-saathi run dev
```

Deploy to Vercel

1 Create a New Project on Vercel

- Go to the Vercel Dashboard → **New Project**.
- Import the GitHub repository `rajsolankar31/saathi`.
- **Configure the Project**:
 - **Project Name**: `saathi` (or any name you prefer).
 - **Root Directory**: `artifacts/scheme-saathi` (the folder that contains the Vite app).
 - **Framework Preset**: Vite (Vercel detects it automatically).
 - **Build Command**: `pnpm --filter @workspace/scheme-saathi run build`
 - **Output Directory**: `artifacts/scheme-saathi/dist/public` (this is where Vite outputs the static files).

2 Set Environment Variables (none required)

The app is a static front-end, so no env vars are needed for a basic deployment. If you add secret keys later, add them here.

3 Deploy

- Click **Deploy** in the dashboard, or use the Vercel CLI:

```
vercel --prod
```

The CLI will ask for the same settings (project name, root directory, build command, output).

4 Verify Deployment

After the build finishes, Vercel provides a live URL (e.g., `https://saathi.vercel.app`). Open it in a browser and verify that:

- The homepage loads without errors.
- Scheme search, filters, and eligibility checker work.

- Direct registration links open the appropriate government portals.

📁 Repository Structure (relevant parts)

```
SchemeSaathi-MVP/
├─ artifacts/
│   └─ scheme-saathi/           # <-- Vite React app (root for Vercel)
│       ├── src/                # Source code (App.tsx, scheme-data.ts, ...)
│       ├── dist/               # Build output (generated by `pnpm run build`)
│       └─ package.json         # Workspace package.json (contains build script)
├─ README.md                   # Project overview (used for this guide)
├─ start.bat                   # Windows one-click dev script
└─ HOW_TO_START.txt            # Plain-text quick-start guide
```

📄 Summary of Commands

Task	Command	Description
Clone repo	git clone https://github.com/rajsolankar31/saathi.git	Retrieve the code.
Install pnpm (global)	npm i -g pnpm	One-time setup.
Install deps	pnpm install	Installs workspace packages.
Run dev server	npx pnpm --filter @workspace/scheme-saathi run dev	Local development.
Build for production	pnpm --filter @workspace/scheme-saathi run build	Generates static files.
Deploy (CLI)	vercel --prod	Pushes to Vercel.

✅ Done!

You now have a complete guide that you can share with teammates or keep for reference. The file `DEPLOY_TO_VERCEL.md` lives in the repository root. Feel free to open it directly from the GitHub web UI or download it locally.

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